

1928–1939

PARED DOWN AND SPORTY

Sport continued to play a part in pushing fashion forward, although women did not take up new sports during this period. “Form follows function” was the guiding principle for clothing worn for physical activities. This usually meant partial or complete abandonment of ornament, which resulted in a pared-down and modern look. Particularly in America, the term sportswear became common not just for clothes worn for tennis or golf, but also for resort wear designed for travel and leisure, and for casual but smart clothing for town and country. The aviatrix Amelia Earhart designed a range of sportswear for American department stores. Pyjamas – ensembles incorporating wide-legged trousers – continued to be a fashionable choice for the beach and on the yacht, and provided scope for innovative designs.

FOR THE YACHT

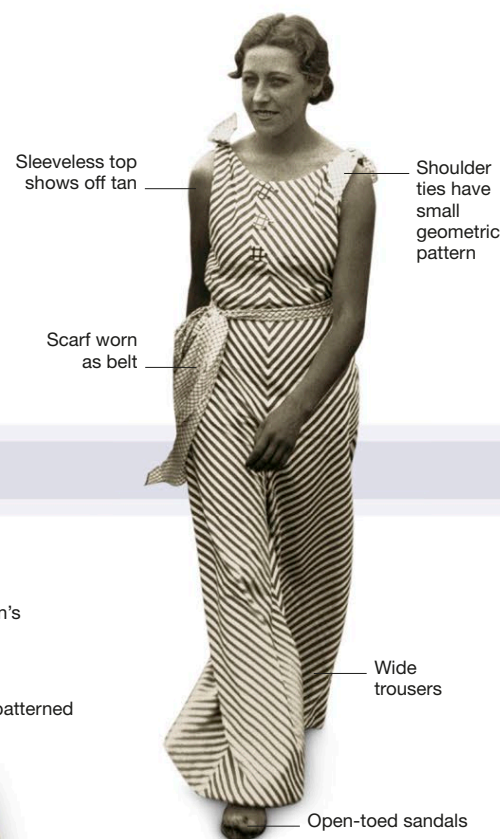
Sailing for pleasure was a relatively new phenomenon, requiring a special set of clothing. Etiquette books and magazines advised planning so that all occasions were covered. This advertisement for Clarks shoes was probably intended to appeal to the aspirational shopper.



Clarks shoes advertisement



Pyjamas de Bateau Paris-based Jane Regny, a golf and tennis player herself, was known for her sports and travel clothes such as these boat pyjamas illustrated in *Femina*. The uniform of sailors and sea captains inspired these nautical creations.



On the beach The English aviatrix Amy Johnson Mollison wore beach pyjamas for a party in 1933. She and her husband had just flown non-stop to the US, surviving a crash-landing in Connecticut.



Aero-sportswoman To keep out the cold, aviators customarily wore leather clothing. Amelia Earhart, here photographed in 1928 before crossing the Atlantic, reportedly slept in her first leather jacket for three days to make it look worn.